

Git Game

Print-and-play, deck v0.1 · for playtesting · the name is not final

What's in this file

- 60 commit cards and 30 command cards — shuffle these together into one draw deck.
- 8 incident cards — a separate face-down pile.
- 6 secret tickets — deal one to each player, face down.
- 4 optional role cards — deal one each, or leave them out for your first game.
- 1 initial-commit card, a reference sheet, and a token sheet.
- 13 card pages at 9 cards per page. Print single-sided on thick paper, or sleeve the cards with opaque backs: face-down cards must not be readable through the paper.

Setup

- Put the initial-commit card in the middle of the table. This is the start of main.
- Give each player a pointer token and place it on the initial commit. Everyone starts up to date.
- Shuffle commit and command cards together. Deal 5 cards to each player.
- Deal one secret ticket to each player. Shuffle the incident pile.
- Release: the game ends when main has this many commits — 2 players: 10, 3: 12, 4–5: 15 — or when someone plays git tag v1.0 at that point.
- Keep merge, grudge and sin tokens in the middle. Cut them from the token sheet or use coins.

Playtesting

The rules live in docs/design/base-rules.md and this deck in rules/deck.json. After a game, write down: what was tense, what was boring, where the rules were unclear, and who won and why. That report is the most valuable thing this deck can produce.

Turn reference

Your turn

1. Draw 2 cards (new tickets came in).
2. Spend 3 ops, in any order.
3. Say a real commit message out loud when you commit. "fix", "wip" or "asdf" draws a bug.

Ops

git add (1) — move any number of hand cards to your staging area, face down.

git commit (1) — all staged cards become ONE commit on your local branch.

git push (1) — move your local commits onto the end of main. Rejected if your pointer is not at the tip. The op is still spent.

git pull (1) — move your pointer to the tip. Take a merge token (-1 at release).

git pull --rebase (2) — same, no merge token.

play a command card (its printed cost).

Merge conflicts

When you pull, if any of your unpushed commits touches the same file as a commit you're pulling in, you have a conflict. Choose:

ours — keep yours; their commit is flipped and crossed out, its author loses those lines and gives you a grudge token (-1 at release).

theirs — discard your commit.

resolve (+1 op) — keep both.

The commit-size gamble

One big commit scores its lines all at once but costs one op. If one card inside is a bug and it is blamed, the whole commit takes the penalty. Small commits are safe and slow.

Bugs and blame

About one card in five is a bug. It is printed on the face; only the holder knows. You may push it.

git blame flips a commit. A bug costs its author -3 on the spot. A bug hidden in a squashed commit costs -5.

revert neutralises a face-up bug: it no longer counts at release. +1 for the fixer.

Release (CI)

When main reaches the target size, anyone may play git tag v1.0 (1 op). Flip every commit on main. Each bug: -3 to its author.

If 4 or more bugs reached production, the release fails: the player with the LEAST blame wins.

Otherwise: lines shipped - blame - merge tokens - grudges - sins + secret ticket.

Incidents

Flip one incident at the start of every round (before the first player's turn). It applies to everyone this round.

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

auth.js

+1

lines

auth.js

+2

lines

auth.js

+2

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

auth.js

+3

lines

auth.js

+3

lines

auth.js

+4

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

auth.js

+4

lines

auth.js

+5

lines

auth.js

+5

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

auth.js

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

auth.js

+7

lines

auth.js

+8

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

api.py

+1

lines

api.py

+2

lines

api.py

+2

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

api.py

+3

lines

api.py

+3

lines

api.py

+4

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

api.py

+4

lines

api.py

+5

lines

api.py

+5

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

api.py

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

api.py

+7

lines

api.py

+8

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

styles.css

+1

lines

styles.css

+2

lines

styles.css

+2

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

styles.css

+3

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

styles.css

+3

lines

styles.css

+4

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

styles.css

+4

lines

styles.css

+5

lines

styles.css

+5

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

styles.css

+6

lines

styles.css

+7

lines

styles.css

+8

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game	COMMIT Git Game	COMMIT Git Game
Dockerfile +1 lines	Dockerfile +2 lines	Dockerfile +2 lines
COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +3 lines BUG Only you can see this. Push it anyway?	COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +3 lines	COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +4 lines
COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +4 lines	COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +5 lines	COMMIT Git Game Dockerfile +5 lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

Dockerfile

+6

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

Dockerfile

+7

lines

Dockerfile

+8

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

README . md

+1

lines

README . md

+2

lines

README . md

+2

lines

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

COMMIT

Git Game

README . md

+3

lines

README . md

+3

lines

README . md

+4

lines

BUG

Only you can see this. Push it anyway?

COMMIT Git Game README . md +4 lines	COMMIT Git Game README . md +5 lines	COMMIT Git Game README . md +5 lines
COMMIT Git Game README . md +6 lines BUG Only you can see this. Push it anyway?	COMMIT Git Game README . md +7 lines	COMMIT Git Game README . md +8 lines
COMMAND Git Game git blame Flip one commit on main. If it holds a bug, its author takes -3 blame now. The commit stays face-up. cost: 1 op	COMMAND Git Game git blame Flip one commit on main. If it holds a bug, its author takes -3 blame now. The commit stays face-up. cost: 1 op	COMMAND Git Game git blame Flip one commit on main. If it holds a bug, its author takes -3 blame now. The commit stays face-up. cost: 1 op

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COMMANDGit Game	COMMANDGit Game	COMMANDGit Game
git bisect Point at a range of main. If any bug is in it, its owner must say which half it is in. Halve until found, then flip it: -3 to its author. cost: 1 op	cherry-pick Copy one commit from main onto your local branch (use a spare card as the copy). The original author stays the author, including for blame. cost: 1 op	cherry-pick Copy one commit from main onto your local branch (use a spare card as the copy). The original author stays the author, including for blame. cost: 1 op
COMMANDGit Game	COMMANDGit Game	COMMANDGit Game
cherry-pick Copy one commit from main onto your local branch (use a spare card as the copy). The original author stays the author, including for blame. cost: 1 op	push --force Overwrite main with your local branch. Every commit after your pointer is erased and goes back to its owner's local branch. Take a Sin token. cost: 1 op	push --force Overwrite main with your local branch. Every commit after your pointer is erased and goes back to its owner's local branch. Take a Sin token. cost: 1 op

COMMAND Git Game	COMMAND Git Game	COMMAND Git Game
push --force Overwrite main with your local branch. Every commit after your pointer is erased and goes back to its owner's local branch. Take a Sin token. cost: 1 op	reflog Play at any time, even on someone else's turn, right after a push --force: the erased commits come back on top of main. Free to play. cost: free	reflog Play at any time, even on someone else's turn, right after a push --force: the erased commits come back on top of main. Free to play. cost: free
COMMAND Git Game reflog Play at any time, even on someone else's turn, right after a push --force: the erased commits come back on top of main. Free to play. cost: free	COMMAND Git Game revert Choose a face-up bug on main. Put this card on top of it as a revert: it no longer counts as a bug at release. +1 for you. cost: 1 op	COMMAND Git Game revert Choose a face-up bug on main. Put this card on top of it as a revert: it no longer counts as a bug at release. +1 for you. cost: 1 op
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COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game	
stash Set up to 3 cards from your hand aside, face down. They are safe from any discard effect. Take them back for free on a later turn. cost: 1 op		commit --amend Swap one card in your last unpushed commit with a card from your hand. On a commit that is already on main: +1 Sin. cost: 1 op		commit --amend Swap one card in your last unpushed commit with a card from your hand. On a commit that is already on main: +1 Sin. cost: 1 op	
COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game	
rebase -i Squash two or more of your unpushed commits into one. +2 lines for clean history. A bug found inside a squashed commit costs -5 instead of -3. cost: 1 op		rebase -i Squash two or more of your unpushed commits into one. +2 lines for clean history. A bug found inside a squashed commit costs -5 instead of -3. cost: 1 op		rebase -i Squash two or more of your unpushed commits into one. +2 lines for clean history. A bug found inside a squashed commit costs -5 instead of -3. cost: 1 op	
COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game		COMMANDGit Game	
checkout <sha> Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -C. cost: 1 op		checkout <sha> Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -C. cost: 1 op		checkout <sha> Target a player. They are in Detached HEAD: their next commit is discarded unless they first spend 1 op on git switch -C. cost: 1 op	

INCIDENTGit Game		INCIDENTGit Game		INCIDENTGit Game	
Friday Deploy Everyone must push this round. Anyone who doesn't loses 1 op next round. flip one at the start of each round		left-pad Unpublished Every Dockerfile commit on main becomes a bug. Flip them face-up now. flip one at the start of each round		Merge Freeze Nobody can push this round. flip one at the start of each round	
INCIDENTGit Game		INCIDENTGit Game		INCIDENTGit Game	
Flaky CI The next push this round rolls a die. On 1 or 2 it is rejected; the op is spent. flip one at the start of each round		Standup Ran Long Everyone has 2 ops this round instead of 3. flip one at the start of each round		Stack Overflow Is Down No command cards this round. flip one at the start of each round	
INCIDENTGit Game		INCIDENTGit Game		SECRET TICKETGit Game	
Hackathon Everyone has 4 ops this round. flip one at the start of each round		Security Audit Going around the table, each player flips one commit on main that is not their own. Blame applies. flip one at the start of each round		Linear History Purist Finish the game with zero merge tokens. +3 at release · keep hidden	

SECRET TICKETGit Game		SECRET TICKETGit Game		SECRET TICKETGit Game	
Owens Auth Have three auth.js commits on main at release. +3 at release · keep hidden		Release Manager Be the player who tags v1.0. +3 at release · keep hidden		Chaos Agent At release, each of your bugs on main scores +3 for you instead of -3. +3 at release · keep hidden	
SECRET TICKETGit Game		SECRET TICKETGit Game		ROLE (OPTIONAL)Git Game	
Documentation Hero Have three README.md commits on main at release. +3 at release · keep hidden		Small Batches Never make a commit with more than one card in it. +3 at release · keep hidden		The Intern Once per game, push without being up to date. Start with 2 extra cards. The first blame against you is ignored: they're learning. deal one per player, or skip roles	
ROLE (OPTIONAL)Git Game		ROLE (OPTIONAL)Git Game		ROLE (OPTIONAL)Git Game	
The Rebase Zealot pull --rebase costs you 1 op. Plain pull costs you 2. deal one per player, or skip roles		The Senior Reviewer Once per round, secretly peek at any face-down commit on main. deal one per player, or skip roles		The 10x Dev You have 4 ops per turn. Every commit you make must hold at least 3 cards. deal one per player, or skip roles	

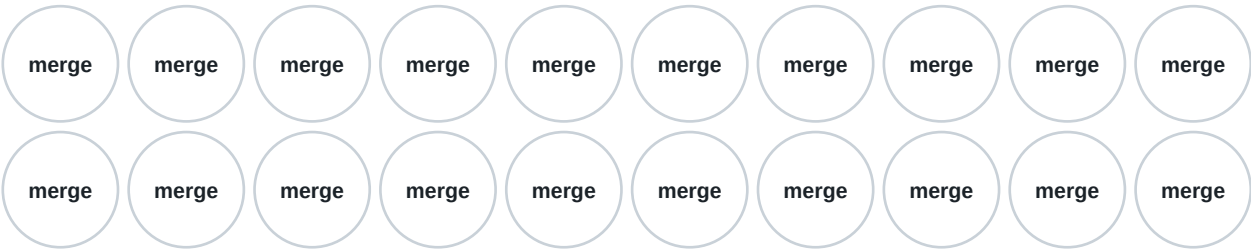
initial commit

start of main · everyone's pointer begins here

Tokens

Cut along the lines, or use coins, paper clips and dice instead. Pointer tokens go on main; one color per player.

merge (-1)



grudge (-1)



sin (-1)



pointer tokens (2 per player)

